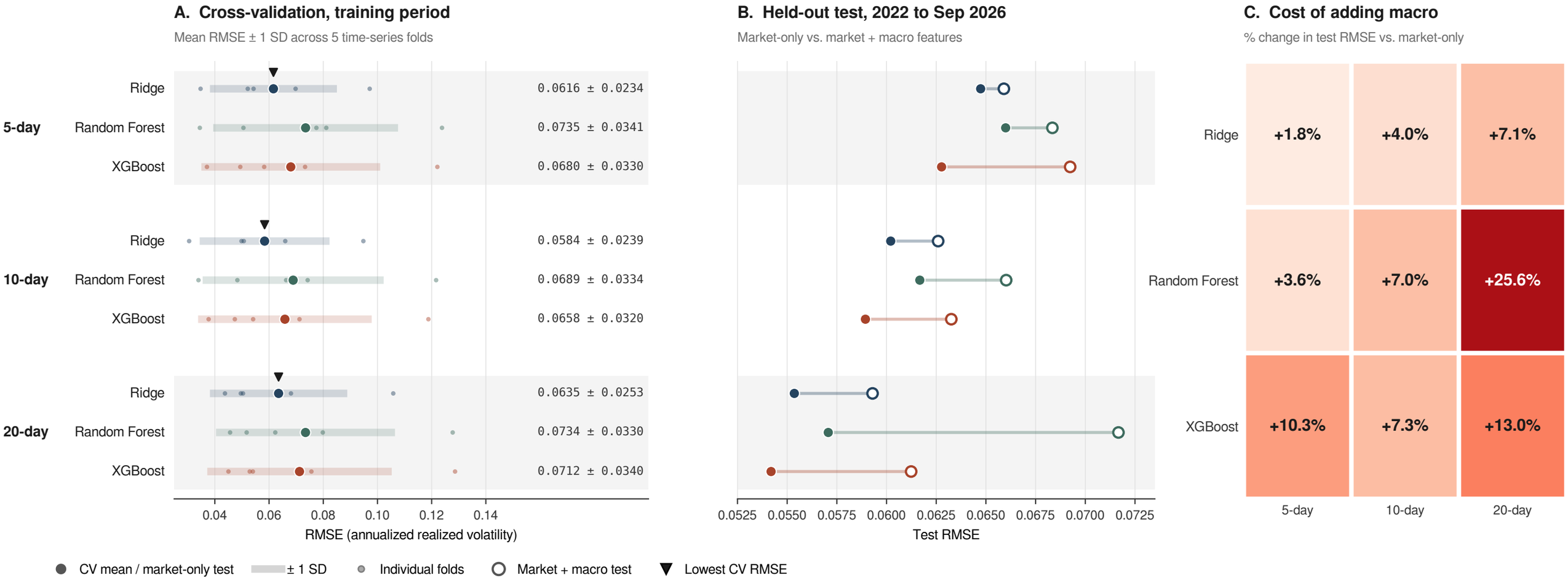
Ridge has the lowest cross-validated error, and macro features raise test error for every model

XGBoost's small test-period edge (0.001 to 0.002) is far inside one cross-validation standard deviation (about 0.023).



Note: CV uses 5 expanding-window folds on training data through Dec 2018, with a gap equal to the forecast horizon to prevent overlapping targets leaking across folds. Market-only features in panel A.